

Manmohan Singh: Will He Be Fit to Lead?

FEBRUARY 9, 2009

The unprecedented situation of having a headless government following Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's heart surgery on the eve of a crucial general election brings out the leadership confusion within the Congress.



“ There's a need for a constitutional 'next-in-command' who would take over during the prime minister's non-availability due to foreign trips, illness or any other unavoidable circumstances. ”

M.C. JOSHI, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Prime Time Crisis

The crisis brought to the fore the infirmities of the Indian political system—a huge and complex country like India could run without a functional head of government, and successfully. But going by our own past precedents, fitness has never been a prerequisite to lead India.

However, Manmohan's illness has surely added a new twist to the power struggle within the Congress and the UPA.

DR VITULL K. GUPTA,
via www.indiatoday.in

The ad hoc manner in which roles were fragmented in Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's absence show rank immaturity and is ludicrous. The question of a second-in-command would not have arisen if a constitutional



Mob Culture

The murderous attack demonstrates the cruel Talibanisation of our secular spirit ("Snowball Effect, February 9). These religious fanatics, who have become emboldened to perpetrate such heinous crimes, need to be controlled, lest the country slips into an unredeemable state of anarchy and disharmony.

THARCIUS S. FERNANDO, *via www.indiatoday.in*

There are genuine concerns about the corruption of young minds resulting in the eventual erosion of value systems, but the manner in which self-styled moral guardians expressed it is reprehensible. We should not dismiss it as spurious or obscurantist. The young need to learn to strike the right balance.

J.S. ACHARYA, *via www.indiatoday.in*

arrangement for a designated functionary to take charge, or be available to morph automatically into a chief executive in the event of the premier's temporary unavailability, would have been in place.

BISHAN SAHAI,

via www.indiatoday.in

As a fitting tribute to young India, an emerging superpower, we certainly need a fitter and a younger person as the next prime minister.

D.B.N. MURTHY,

via www.indiatoday.in

Con Man

B. Ramalinga Raju's violent ambitions scripted the saga of his disgrace that have jeopardised the prospects of the IT industry, goodwill of a country, credibility of the system, future of thousands of

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